

A SAMPLE LESSON

The Framework

BOOK TWO · GRADES 3-5

Unit 1 · Lesson 1 — “Who Am I?”

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CURRICULUM

The Architecture of Grace Foundation

Who Am I?

35–40 min · Week 1 · “Who am I — and can I hold that honestly, without shame and without pretending?”

OBJECTIVE	Students identify at least three personal strengths or values and articulate why each student is uniquely worthwhile.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness — identifying personal strengths and self-perception.
VOCABULARY	identity · strength · value · character
MATERIALS	Journals · drawing supplies · WS1 Identity Web · character strengths list · index cards

LESSON AT A GLANCE

The goal is not content coverage — it is trust and safety. Go slowly. Prioritize the opening story. Every student must leave with their name on the class display.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · 6 STEPS

- Opening Story** 0–3 MIN
 Before you hand students anything, tell them what you are building: *once a week, for about 40 minutes, we are going to work on the inside of your life — not your grades, but the part of you that decides how you treat yourself when things go wrong.* Promise the journal privacy contract. Establish: feelings are information, not weaknesses. Every person is more than their worst moment.
- Classroom Compact** 3–8 MIN
 Ask: *what do you need this space to feel like to be honest here?* Ensure these four are included: (1) What is shared here stays here. (2) You never have to share more than you choose. (3) Feelings are information. (4) The Inner Coach standard applies to how we speak to each other. Post permanently.
- Identity Web (WS1)** 8–18 MIN
 Distribute WS1. Students write their name in the center and branch out — Things I Love · Good At · Matter to Me · People Don’t Know · Still Figuring Out. Grade 3: drawing is a full response. Grades 4–5: push toward values, not just interests.
- Strengths Inventory** 18–26 MIN
 Display the character strengths list. Students circle three that feel most true and write one sentence for each. Grade 3: circle only. Grades 4–5: which strength required the most work to build?

IN-LESSON SCAN

During partner share, scan for any student who sits silently while their partner speaks, or who says “I don’t know” to every prompt. A student unable to name a single thing about themselves is giving you early, significant data about self-perception.

5

Partner Share

26–32 MIN

Students tell one partner one thing from their identity web. Listen without commenting. Switch. *What did it feel like to just be heard?*

6

Index Card + Class Display

32–36 MIN

Students write one true thing about themselves that often goes unseen. Post voluntarily. *Look at this wall. This is who we are.* No student leaves without a card on the wall.

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students write their index cards, watch for prolonged blank staring, repeated erasing, or a student who writes and immediately crumples the card. These students may be carrying a strong internal voice that says nothing about them is worth posting.

GRADE 3

Keep the identity web simple and drawing-focused. Reduce the strengths list to 10–12. Every child must see their name on the wall by end of lesson.

GRADES 4–5

Encourage depth — push toward values, not interests. Introduce born strengths vs. developed strengths. The index card should name a value.

SCENARIO CARD 1-A • “WHO AM I?”

Marcus shared on his identity web that he loves drawing comics. A classmate said, “That’s babyish.” Marcus feels embarrassed and wishes he had said something else. *Is Marcus’s love of comics part of who he truly is? What would you say to help him hold his identity with confidence?*

EXIT TICKET • JOURNAL

“One true thing about me that I want to carry into this school year is ____.”

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled to identify strengths — defaulting to “I don’t know” or minimizing? This is early data about self-perception that will matter all year.

THIS LESSON INCLUDES

Anchor Chart

Worksheet WS1

Scenario Cards 1-A / 1-B

END OF THE SAMPLE LESSON

One of 28 lessons across four units.

The Framework • Book Two of The Architecture of Grace • Grades 3–5